Agile Team Charter – LaunchPad.dev

1. Team Purpose & Vision

Team Mission:

-To design, validate, and prototype *LaunchPadDev* - a student-focused career acceleration platform that helps final-year ICT students and recent graduates in Cape Town transition from academic learning to employment. As a PRP372S WIL team, we deliver a realistic, feasible business concept, supported by validated research and a working prototype, within the July-October 2026 Timeline.

Problem Statement:

-There is a gap between academic knowledge and real-world job readiness for final-year ICT students and recent graduates in Cape Town. Many lack professional portfolios, interview practice, industry connections, and feedback on their CVs and GitHub profiles- leaving them underprepared for the job market despite holding relevant qualifications.

Vision Statement:

-To become the leading student career acceleration platform in Cape Town, empowering ICT graduates with real-world skills, industry exposure, and job readiness.

Project Scope

In Scope	Out Of Scope
Business concept development and validation	Full commercial launch or revenue generation
Market and customer research (Surveys, interviews)	Paid marketing campaigns
Prototype of the four core features	Full production-grade backend infrastructure
Agile project documentation and artefacts	Legal Incorporation/IP registration
Pitch presentation and final deployed application	Post-subject maintenance and support

Success Definition:

We will consider this project successful if:

- **100%** of deliverables are submitted on or before their deadlines (tracked on Trello)
- The solution is realistic, structured, and technically feasible (validated by lecturer feedback and a technical feasibility review)
- We achieve a **minimum final mark of 70%+**, with positive lecturer feedback against the PRP372S rubric
- The business idea is validated through **at least [15] customer discovery interactions** (surveys/interviews) with the target market, with findings documented
- **100%** team participation is evidenced in meeting minutes and Trello activity logs

Product / Service Deliverables:

- **Portfolio Builder** — helps students create a professional project portfolio
- **Mock Interview Arena** — interview practice with feedback
- **Mentor Matching System** — connects students with industry mentors
- **CV & GitHub Audit Tool** — automated feedback on CVs and GitHub profiles

-Each deliverable has a defined owner, acceptance criteria, and a Trello card linked to a milestone (Section 7).

2. Team Members & Roles

Name	Role	Key Responsibilities
Reotshepile Stock	Agile Lead (Scrum Master)	Oversees progress, facilitates Agile ceremonies, removes blockers, maintains Trello board and charter
Lucky Twala	Technical & Feasibility Lead	Ensures technical feasibility, supports Agile practices, provides technical input, leads prototype architecture
Qhubekani Shandu	Developer / Research Lead	Conducts market and customer research, refines the business idea, creates diagrams (business model canvas, user flows)
Pertunia Sifunda	Analyst / Marketing Lead	Conducts customer analysis, develops marketing strategy, performs quality checks against the rubric

3. Ways of Working

3.1 Agile Framework

-We will use the **Kanban methodology**, supported by **Trello**, to manage tasks and workflow. Our board columns are: *Backlog → To Do → In Progress → Review → Done*. Work-in-progress limits: **maximum 2 active cards per member** to prevent overload. Every card has an owner, due date, and acceptance criteria.

3.2 Agile Ceremonies

Ceremony	Frequency	Purpose	Duration		
Daily Stand-up	Daily	Track progress, identify blockers and re-plan the day	15-30Mins, Microsoft Teams		
Sprint Planning	Start of sprint	Assign tasks, define sprint goals and priorities	45 mins		
Review / Demo	End of sprint	Present completed work against acceptance criteria	3o minutes		
Retrospective	End of sprint	Reflect on what went well, what didn't and improve team performance.	30 minutes		

4. Working Agreements

We agree to:

- Be punctual and prepared for all meetings (agenda and prior work reviewed beforehand)
- Respect deadlines and time constraints; flag risks to a deadline **at least 48 hours in advance**
- Communicate clearly, respectfully, and professionally in all channels
- Raise issues or blockers early - within **24 hours** of becoming aware of them
- Support each other as a team and share knowledge openly
- Commit to continuous improvement by acting on retrospective actions
- Update Trello **before** starting and **after** completing a task, so the board reflects reality
- Attend all scheduled meetings; if unable, notify the team in advance and review the minutes

5. Communication Plan

Primary Communication Channels

- Microsoft Teams
- WhatsApp Group

Response Time Expectations

- Academic hours: within 2–4 hours
- Urgent matters: within 1 hour

Remote Work Norms

- Attend all scheduled online meetings
- Stay active and responsive
- Participation is required (camera optional)

6. Decision-Making Process

- **Primary approach:** Consensus - all members contribute, and a decision is adopted when no member has an unresolved objection.
- **If unresolved:** the Agile Lead makes the final decision after team input, and the rationale is recorded in the minutes.
- **Time-box:** decisions are time-boxed to **one meeting (max 30 minutes of discussion)**; otherwise, they escalate.

Escalation Path

1. Discuss within the team and attempt consensus
2. Escalate to the Agile Lead (Reotshepile Stock), who decides and records the outcome
3. Seek lecturer guidance ([Ms Prima, PRP372S) if the issue remains unresolved

7.Goals & Milestones Timeline

Milestone	Target Date	Owner	Deliverable / Evidence
Charter submission	1 April 2026	Reotshepile	Approved charter (this document)
Research & validation complete	June 2026	Qhubekani	Research report, survey/interview findings, business model canvas
Prototype / design completed	July 2026	Lucky	Wireframes, user flows, feature specs
Backend design	August 2026	Lucky	Data model, API/architecture diagram
Frontend design	August 2026	Lucky + Pertunia	UI screens / clickable prototype
Deployment and testing	September 2026	Lucky + Pertunia	Tested prototype, QA checklist, demo

Final pitch & submission	October 2026	All	Pitch deck, final report, prototype demo

8. Definition of Done (DoD)

A task is considered complete when:

- Work is finished and reviewed by **at least one other team member** (peer review recorded on Trello)
- Content is accurate and meets the relevant **PRP372S rubric requirements** (checked against the rubric checklist)
- Document is properly formatted, spell-checked, and consistent with the charter's standards
- All team members have reviewed and approved (or raised no unresolved objection within 24 hours)
- The Trello card is moved to **Done** with a link to the evidence
- It is ready for final submission without further edits

9. Core Values & Agile Principles

Core Values

- **Respect** - for each other's time, ideas, and contributions
- **Transparency** - visible progress, honest reporting of blockers, shared information
- **Accountability** - owners deliver on commitments and flag risks early
- **Trust** - assume good intent; support each other under pressure
- **Continuous learning** - improve through retrospectives and feedback

Agile Principles (as applied to this project)

- **Individuals and interactions** over processes and tools - we prioritise team communication and collaboration
- **Working solutions** over extensive documentation - the prototype and validated concept matter more than paperwork volume
- **Customer collaboration** over contract negotiation - we engage real students and stakeholders to validate the idea
- **Responding to change** over following a fixed plan - we adapt scope and priorities through retrospectives and re-planning

10.Risks, Assumptions, Dependencies & Constraints

Known Risks (with mitigation)

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
Poor time management	Medium	High	Sprint planning, Trello due dates, 48-hour early warning rule
Unequal participation	Medium	High	Named deliverable ownership, stand-ups, peer review, escalation path
Limited technical understanding	Medium	Medium	Technical Lead support, upskilling sessions, scoped prototype
Scope creep	Medium	Medium	In/out-of-scope list (Section 1.4); changes only via team consensus
Loss of work / data	Low	High	Work stored in Teams/cloud with version history; regular commits

Assumptions

- All team members remain available for the full July–October 2026 period
- The lecturer provides timely rubric feedback at agreed checkpoints
- Target users (final-year ICT students) are accessible for research and validation
- Free/low-cost tools (Trello, Teams, prototype tools) remain available

Dependencies

- Team collaboration and availability
- Reliable internet access for remote meetings and cloud tools
- Timely lecturer feedback and rubric clarity
- Access to research participants (students and graduates)

Constraints

- **Tight deadlines** (April–May 2026) - scope must remain realistic
- **No funding** (student project) - free tools only; no paid services
- **Skill gaps** in development and analysis - mitigated by role allocation and peer learning

11.Review & Continuous Improvement

- The charter will be reviewed during **retrospectives** at the end of each sprint, and updated only by team consensus (recorded in minutes)
- Retrospective actions are logged on Trello with owners and due dates, and reviewed at the next retrospective